



“ We are pivoting our clients’ selection across the corporate, small and medium enterprises and mid-corporate spectrum towards well-rated clients ”

GANESH SANKARAN

GROUP EXECUTIVE, WHOLESAL
BANKING COVERAGE GROUP,
AXIS BANK



“ Currently, the bank’s secured and unsecured share is about 80:20. Unsecured offers a healthy risk-adjusted return... We would like to move directionally towards 75:25 ”

SUMIT BALI

GROUP EXECUTIVE AND HEAD,
RETAIL LENDING, AXIS BANK



“ We are bringing more granularity in our deposits, which are stickier in nature. Corporate deposits generally have the risk of run-off as they come in and get out fast ”

RAVI NARAYANAN

GROUP EXECUTIVE, RETAIL
LIABILITIES AND BRANCH
BANKING, AXIS BANK

| 27

PHOTOS BY **MANDAR DEODHAR**

its personal loans, which make up 11 per cent of its retail loans, from salaried customers. Under auto, the bank is increasing its share of used cars, where it is already the second-largest player. Another fast-growing segment is business banking, which has a share of 7 per cent.

Chaudhry also created a separate vertical for retail liabilities with branches servicing existing customers and an independent liability sales team focussing on new customer acquisitions. To head this vertical, he brought in Ravi Narayanan, who was HDFC Bank’s Head-Branch Banking (West) and Retail Trade & Forex, last May. “We are bringing more granularity to our deposits, which are stickier in nature. As you know, corporate deposits generally have the risk of run-off as they come in and get out fast,” says Narayanan, who is now Group Executive of Retail Liabilities and Branch Banking at Axis Bank.

The bank has already implemented a premiumisation strategy focussing on improving deposit account quality. Its premium segment includes private banking, Burgundy (a tech-driven wealth management platform), Priority,

Prestige and NRIs. The Citi acquisition brings in 1,600-plus Suvidha corporate relationships with more than 1 million customers. As a result, the low-cost CASA ratio of the bank will jump from around 45 per cent to 47 per cent. This will go a long way towards improving the net interest margins and, consequently, the ROE, the bank says.

THE CITI ACQUISITION will also energise Axis’s wealth management business. Over the years, it has organically built Burgundy, with assets under management (AUM) of more than ₹2.67 lakh crore in December 2021. The bank claims it is now the third-largest wealth management player in India. It will get the wealth and private banking businesses of Citi, which has a total AUM of ₹1.1 lakh crore. “The deal would help Axis add more premium customers to its Burgundy platform [with] the potential to cross-sell Axis products and offerings,” says Arora of Sharekhan by BNP Paribas.

Chaudhry also hired Sharda from Future Life to en-